

The evening: what arrives, and when

Discoveries add context and suspicion. Official exhibits establish the crime facts before voting.

ARRIVAL	Introduce yourselves. Memorize and return your animal slip.	A separate matching bowl selects only an attending guest. The branch stays fixed all evening.
HUNT FOR CLUES	Find, read and display all sixteen envelopes. The host supplies missed finds.	13: acquisition receipt. 14: conservator objection. 16: private toast schedule. Other finds expose scandals.
ACT I: MOTIVE	Release Evidence 1 (gift terms) and 2 (empty acquired bottle). Everyone answers.	The takeover gives many guests motives. The bottle has been opened; this does not identify who opened it.
ACT II: OPPORTUNITY	Release Evidence 3: the caterer’s photos and signed handling record.	The new donor glass is set at 6:32. Guests circulate while the server is in the kitchen. At 6:44 the glass goes onto the service tray.
ACT III: METHOD	Release Evidence 4 (bottle access and room plan) and 5 (lab and material records).	The bottle’s damaged band was hidden from a casual front view. Punch and food are clear. Inventory records disclose each guest’s own material.
ACCUSATIONS	Discuss, submit ballots, tally and lock votes.	All necessary facts are available now. Nobody needs a confession to solve the case.
COMING CLEAN	Hear the top three suspects. If none confesses, call the selected animal.	Endings connect existing facts and resolve other scandals; they introduce no essential new evidence.

How evidence turns an account into a deduction

Two actions are necessary. Four late arrivals block source access. Twenty-six individual records supply context without complete alibis.

TAKE THE POISON
Preparation shelf / 6:20–6:28 / Evidence 2 + 4

AND

REACH INSIDE THE GLASS
Donor Salon / 6:32–6:44 / Evidence 3 + 5

ACCOUNT TYPE	IF INNOCENT + EVIDENCE	IF MURDERER + EVIDENCE
Ordinary corroboration	Retained drafts, photographs, invoices and correspondence explain distinct scandals without synchronized alibis.	The guest’s inventory records material similar to the bottle band and glass fragment.
First admission	Four guests first enter after the bottle has been returned to the locked cupboard.	The guilty branch places its guest at the earlier walkthrough.
Material and access	The innocent record supplies a separate, corroborated explanation for the suspicious object or action.	Tour access, an uncovered-glass encounter and the inventory scrap jointly support the accusation.

Twenty-six contextual accounts explain misconduct without proving complete alibis. Chip, Dada and Minnie also have legitimate uses for this shared foil-backed red stock. The suspicious inventory record must be weighed together with bottle access, the glass encounter and the account of the guest’s scandal. A material match alone cannot identify the murderer. This is a strongest-case inference with residual doubt; do not present contextual records as guaranteed exoneration.

Artie Ficial / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	Grant attached my resignation to his gift. I had accepted a job at another museum and had not told the board. He planned to present my departure as their price for keeping the collection. I wanted the chair to hear the terms before he announced them.	Grant attached my resignation to his gift. I had accepted a job at another museum and had not told the board. He planned to present my departure as their price for keeping the collection. I wanted that announcement stopped.
OPPORTUNITY	I forged a signed letter from Grant demanding my resignation, then sent it to the chair. Grant had made it a condition of his gift; I wanted the board forced to debate the demand before accepting his unsigned gift agreement. I spent the welcome reception trying to reach the chair, then took her call in my office. The speech folder was on my desk. I had not agreed to the resignation, whatever his signature on my forged letter appeared to say.	I forged a signed letter from Grant demanding my resignation, then sent it to the chair. Grant had made it a condition of his gift; I wanted the board forced to debate the demand before accepting his unsigned gift agreement. I spent the welcome reception trying to reach the chair, then took her call in my office. The speech folder was on my desk. I had not agreed to the resignation, whatever his signature on my forged letter appeared to say.
METHOD	The chair called while I was in my office. She wanted the resignation read to the board before the announcement; I kept the call running until we heard the toast through the gallery doors. The signed demand in my folder is a forgery I made to force that discussion. The chair's call log and my marked draft record what we were arguing about. I intended to leave Grant with a board dispute he could not announce away.	The signature on that resignation demand is the one I copied. Grant never signed it. I put the demand in his speech folder so that he would have to answer it before the board. I had not agreed to resign on his terms. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my resignation envelope. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved Grant's glass to put the acknowledgment cards where he would read them.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: forged a signed letter.

Claire O’Scuro / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I concealed the independent review from the board. The Star Bowl label now presents a disputed history as settled ownership. That label goes out under my department’s name. Grant supplied the money and expected that to make him the curator. I had spent months building this exhibition; I was angry enough to change its wording without permission.	I concealed the independent review from the board. The Star Bowl label now presents a disputed history as settled ownership. That label goes out under my department’s name. Grant supplied the money and expected that to make him the curator. He was turning the exhibition I had built into evidence for his own claim.
OPPORTUNITY	I changed the exhibition label while the reception was underway. I removed the claim that the Star Bowl's ownership was settled and added the independent review's objection. Grant caught me with the old label in my hand. I told him he could complain to the board with the same incomplete file he had supplied me. He reached for the replacement label. I kept it and the old one.	I changed the exhibition label while the reception was underway. I removed the claim that the Star Bowl's ownership was settled and added the independent review's objection. Grant caught me with the old label in my hand. I told him he could complain to the board with the same incomplete file he had supplied me. He reached for the replacement label. I kept it and the old one.
METHOD	The removed label and the independent review record the same missing permit. The registrar photographed the replacement before Grant objected. My red stain was label ink. The inventory's red proof slip is plain paper, without metallic backing. I had concealed the review, but I did not invent its ownership objection. The signed findings and the retained old label can both be examined.	The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my label folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant’s table. I shifted the glass to lay the provenance proof flat.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: changed the exhibition label.

Hugh Bidder / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	The certificate was forged before it reached me. I then altered my file to hide how badly I had been fooled. Grant intended to call that a forgery of my own unless I refunded millions. My professional judgment was poor. His price for keeping quiet was excellent, for him.	I altered my file after discovering the certificate was false. Grant wanted millions back and a public admission that I had created the forgery. He knew that wasn't true. He preferred an expensive villain to a complicated transaction, especially when he could make the villain pay twice.
OPPORTUNITY	I took the reserve-price call outside before entering. The broker wanted to know why the certificate in my file no longer matched the one sent to the buyer. I said it was a clerical correction. It was concealment. When I finally spoke to Grant, I offered a settlement. He wanted a refund on a scale that would close the firm. He kept the offer; I retained the envelope.	I took the reserve-price call outside before entering. The broker wanted to know why the certificate in my file no longer matched the one sent to the buyer. I said it was a clerical correction. It was concealment. When I finally spoke to Grant, I offered a settlement. He wanted a refund on a scale that would close the firm. He kept the offer; I retained the envelope.
METHOD	I first entered at 6:29, delayed by a dispute over a reserve price. My entrance receipt records that first admission, not a second visit. The certificate in the sale file was false, and my alteration concealed that failure rather than curing it.	I first entered at 6:17, delayed by a dispute over a reserve price. My entrance receipt documents that first admission, not a second visit. The certificate in the sale file was false, and my alteration concealed that failure rather than curing it. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my settlement envelope. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant’s table. I moved his glass out of the way of the offer.

WHY THE INNOCENT ACCOUNT EXCLUDES TAKING THE POISON

Hugh's staff-issued entrance receipt establishes his first arrival after the preparation room closes. The innocent branch explicitly rules out an earlier entry. Apply Evidence 2 + 4.

Suspicious in both branches: concealment.

Monet Bags / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I moved restricted money without authorization. Payroll would have failed before the donation arrived. Grant discovered the transfer and demanded his wing expenses added to it. He could report me for the first transaction while benefiting from the second. I knew what that report would cost.	I moved restricted money without authorization. Payroll would have failed before the donation arrived. Grant discovered the transfer and demanded his wing expenses added to it. He could report me for the first transaction while benefiting from the second. I had no intention of letting him do that.
OPPORTUNITY	The bank called about the restricted account during the reception. I went to the office to stop the transfer being reversed before payroll cleared. There was no board authorization. Grant found me there and offered to overlook it if I added the marble-wing expenses. I refused. He wrote the proposed addition on the ledger, and I pulled the page away before his leaking pen obscured the amounts.	The bank called about the restricted account during the reception. I went to the office to stop the transfer being reversed before payroll cleared. There was no board authorization. Grant found me there and offered to overlook it if I added the marble-wing expenses. I refused. He wrote the proposed addition on the ledger, and I pulled the page away before his leaking pen obscured the amounts.
METHOD	The bank retained the payroll instruction and the board received no authorization from me. Grant's handwritten marble-wing addition is on the ledger I took away from the office. His leaking pen stained the schedule beneath it. The original records salaries and his proposed expense separately. It corroborates the transfer I made and the addition I refused, without making my transfer lawful.	My unauthorized transfer covered salaries. Grant's proposed addition covered a likeness of himself. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my ledger. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. Later, in the salon, I pushed his empty glass aside while he signed the revised payroll schedule. That was after our argument in the office.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: restricted account.

Chip Patina / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I changed a treatment date to meet an insurance deadline. That mistake was mine. Grant wanted a recent repair described as ancient, so that damage would become part of the object’s pedigree. I could correct the date. Once my report went into the exhibition file, people would quote it for years. I refused to give him that report.	I changed a treatment date to meet an insurance deadline. That mistake was mine. Grant wanted a recent repair described as ancient, so that damage would become part of the object’s pedigree. He had seen me compromise one record and assumed I would do it again. I resented how easily he made the second request.
OPPORTUNITY	I had changed the treatment date to meet the insurance deadline. During the walkthrough I replaced the bottle's museum custody band and recorded its condition. Later the crew asked me about the mounting fault. Grant wanted that described as an ancient repair. I went to the closed alcove to look at the defect instead of agreeing with him. My supply sleeve contains unused red foil-backed band strips; they are ordinary stock from our shared materials cabinet.	I had changed the treatment date to meet the insurance deadline. During the walkthrough I replaced the bottle's museum custody band and recorded its condition. Later the crew asked me about the mounting fault. Grant wanted that described as an ancient repair. I went to the closed alcove to look at the defect instead of agreeing with him. My supply sleeve contains unused red foil-backed band strips; they are ordinary stock from our shared materials cabinet.
METHOD	The changed date is on the insurance copy. The original treatment photograph shows the mount before the alteration, and the technician kept that original. I went to the closed alcove to check the defect the crew had reported. The closure notice concerns a real fault; it does not authenticate the date I put on the insurance copy. I will correct that copy. Grant wanted me to authenticate a much larger fiction. The inventory lists unused custody-band stock in my supply sleeve; the before-tour condition photograph records the new band I applied.	I substituted the dated treatment copy for the original Grant had been waving at the insurer. The insurance copy has the altered date. I wanted the original out of Grant's hands before he talked to the insurer. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my treatment file. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant’s table. I moved the glass before laying down the dated treatment copy.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: changed the treatment date.

Dada DiCapo / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	Yes, I wrote the warning. Returning what was taken meant my performance concept, which Grant planned to unveil with himself credited as visionary patron. It was a provocation. He turned my work into an advertisement and then complained that the artist had supplied an uncomfortable caption.	I wrote the warning and meant Grant to feel threatened. He had taken my unreleased performance, stripped out the difficult parts, and awarded himself the credit. He called his version accessible. Theft is quite accessible when somebody else pays for the stage.
OPPORTUNITY	I rehearsed the closing reveal after Grant ordered my name removed from the program. The scene was supposed to make the donor disappear and leave an empty jacket standing under the lights. He canceled it. I intended to run it anyway. The warning was mine, and I had arranged an apparent collapse as part of the performance. I did not announce that plan to the dining room. Surprise was rather the point.	I rehearsed the closing reveal after Grant ordered my name removed from the program. The scene was supposed to make the donor disappear and leave an empty jacket standing under the lights. He canceled it. I intended to run it anyway. The warning was mine, and I had arranged an apparent collapse as part of the performance. I did not announce that plan to the dining room. Surprise was rather the point.
METHOD	The rehearsal photograph shows an empty jacket on a hinged stand. No drink was used in the effect. The stage manager kept the canceled sequence and my notebook sketch, including the original credit. The red foil-backed scraps in my program came from the closing confetti, cut from the shared materials stock. I intended a fake collapse and a public embarrassment. The retained plan records what that effect actually involved.	I wrote the warning. The stage manager had my unapproved revision. Grant wanted his foundation's credit restored before the performance. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my working program. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass to leave the revised program beside it.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character's misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: run it anyway.

Vincent Van Faux / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	The anonymous buybacks were mine. I paid to remove my student paintings from circulation. Grant owned the worst one and wanted it beside my recent work as a joke. A patron buying art is charming. A patron buying the right to humiliate its painter is a different transaction.	I arranged the buybacks because early work should sometimes remain early work. Grant refused to sell his student painting back. He wanted the gala to laugh at it. He had never painted anything, yet tonight he intended to become the author of my reputation.
OPPORTUNITY	I turned my student painting toward the wall and removed its sale notice. Grant had positioned it beside the new work without asking me. I had brought cash to buy it back; he would not name a price. The registrar told me to restore the display. I restored the painting and kept the notice. There was a blank space where I had painted over my own signature years ago. I did not need that pointed out to the room.	I turned my student painting toward the wall and removed its sale notice. Grant had positioned it beside the new work without asking me. I had brought cash to buy it back; he would not name a price. The registrar told me to restore the display. I restored the painting and kept the notice. There was a blank space where I had painted over my own signature years ago. I did not need that pointed out to the room.
METHOD	The replacement sketch is on the back of the student picture's sale notice. The painted-out signature is mine. I prepared the cash before the gala and took it home again when Grant refused. The notice and withdrawal receipt corroborate the buyback I tried to conceal. A very expensive lesson in being ashamed of one's own work.	Grant rejected my replacement sketch. The signature I painted over was mine; I wanted the student work taken out of the exhibition. I had prepared cash for the purchase and did not want its owner to know what I would pay. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my sketch wallet. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass before spreading out the replacement sketch.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: painted over my own signature.

Sue Venir / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I softened the legal opinion and failed to correct Grant when he called it clearance. Both versions still identify a problem with the title. He wanted my name in the announcement and my qualifications left out. I had let the account matter more than the advice. Hearing him use that compromise as my endorsement was unbearable.	I softened the legal opinion and failed to correct Grant when he called it clearance. Both versions still identify a problem with the title. He wanted my name in the announcement and my qualifications left out. I had made myself useful to him by saying less. Now he expected my signature on a claim I did not believe.
OPPORTUNITY	I took a call from opposing counsel in the coatroom. Grant wanted my revised opinion read as clearance of the collection. It was not. I had softened the wording and failed to object when he described it that way. Counsel asked which version would be supplied to the board. I said both. Grant heard the end of that answer and told me there would be consequences for embarrassing his gift.	I took a call from opposing counsel in the coatroom. Grant wanted my revised opinion read as clearance of the collection. It was not. I had softened the wording and failed to object when he described it that way. Counsel asked which version would be supplied to the board. I said both. Grant heard the end of that answer and told me there would be consequences for embarrassing his gift.
METHOD	I retained both legal opinions. The earlier one names the missing permit; the softened version does not withdraw that finding. My assistant's outgoing email has the earlier attachment. I let Grant describe a rewrite as a clearance. The file can show what I actually advised, even if I did not object loudly enough.	I softened the legal opinion for Grant and kept the earlier version. He wanted me to call the ownership finding settled. I took the annex away before he could keep my name beside that claim. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my legal case. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved the glass to keep the signature page flat.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: softened.

Dr. Art E. Fact / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	One inference in my article goes beyond the source. I had sent a correction to the archivist before coming here. Grant wanted the entire article withdrawn. He spoke as though finding one bad sentence made him the better historian. I was embarrassed by the sentence and furious at being asked to abandon the evidence around it.	One inference in my article goes beyond the source. I had sent a correction to the archivist before coming here. Grant wanted the entire article withdrawn. He spoke as though finding one bad sentence made him the better historian. I had spent years on that research, and I could not bear to hear him dismiss it in front of the collection.
OPPORTUNITY	I corrected the citation on the display and then had to correct my own explanation of it. My published inference went beyond the source. Grant wanted a public withdrawal of the whole article. I offered a correction to the sentence that was wrong. We argued in front of the collection rather than in his private room. I wanted the object examined; he wanted my error to end the examination.	I corrected the citation on the display and then had to correct my own explanation of it. My published inference went beyond the source. Grant wanted a public withdrawal of the whole article. I offered a correction to the sentence that was wrong. We argued in front of the collection rather than in his private room. I wanted the object examined; he wanted my error to end the examination.
METHOD	The archive reference confirms the ownership question, but it does not support one sentence in my article. My notes distinguish the passage I read from the inference I added. I sent the archivist my correction before the gala. That is the error Grant had found, and the correspondence verifies it.	I corrected the citation Grant had found wanting. I did not intend to withdraw the ownership challenge with it. He wanted the article discredited as a whole, and I wanted the archive reference considered separately. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my citation folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant’s table. I moved his glass while showing him the amended reference.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: published inference.

Tess Tament / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

IF INNOCENT		IF MURDERER	
MOTIVE	Grant called me ornamental. Then he demanded my signature on the family trust. Apparently ornaments can execute legal documents. I organized the trustees against him. The money was supposed to support people, and his new plan mostly supported a very expensive sign saying GRANT.		Grant called me ornamental while waving a trust amendment that would remove my vote. I organized the trustees against him, but he had enough signatures to destroy our plan tonight. He thought I would cry beautifully and approve the paperwork. I had finished being useful decoration.
OPPORTUNITY	I was calling trustees from the cloakroom, trying to assemble enough votes to block Grant's amendment. I told one of them the others had already agreed. They had not. When Grant asked for my signature, I refused and told him the vote was settled. It was a bluff. I went back to the phone before he could call the trustees himself. The family trust was not supposed to become his private naming fund.		I was calling trustees from the cloakroom, trying to assemble enough votes to block Grant's amendment. I told one of them the others had already agreed. They had not. When Grant asked for my signature, I refused and told him the vote was settled. It was a bluff. I went back to the phone before he could call the trustees himself. The family trust was not supposed to become his private naming fund.
METHOD	The entrance attendant admitted me for the first time at 6:31. My entrance receipt records my first admission at 6:31. The trustee calls were made from the cloakroom after that arrival. The phone log and the written objection corroborate the revolt I was organizing. I bluffed about having enough votes; I did not obtain the missing votes by getting a signature from Grant.		The entrance attendant admitted me for the first time at 6:17. My entrance receipt documents the admission I described. I took the trustees' objection to Grant myself. He mistook a carefully dressed woman for an agreeable signature. The objection was meant to correct that mistake in writing. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my evening bag. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass before laying down the trustees' objection.

WHY THE INNOCENT ACCOUNT EXCLUDES TAKING THE POISON

Tess entered the museum for the first time at 6:31 after the preparation room was locked at 6:28; her entrance receipt is a staff-issued arrival record, not a photo timestamp. No guest access beforehand. Apply Evidence 2 + 4.

Suspicious in both branches: bluff.

Barb Dwyer / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I ordered the camera disconnected. Grant authorized it; the security procedure did not. He wanted privacy and intended to blame my staff if something went wrong. I followed his order and concealed the exception. The officer giving that instruction was me.	I ordered the camera disconnected. Grant authorized it; the security procedure did not. He wanted privacy and intended to blame my staff if something went wrong. I followed his order and concealed the exception. I was not willing to be his explanation for the consequences.
OPPORTUNITY	I had the technician unplug the salon camera. Grant's written instruction authorized it; the safety procedure did not. I checked the gallery doorway camera afterward and left that one running. Then I dealt with the entrance queue. Grant had told me security would take the blame for any problem. I kept his order in my jacket instead of filing the exception report. I knew exactly which part I was failing to document.	I had the technician unplug the salon camera. Grant's written instruction authorized it; the safety procedure did not. I checked the gallery doorway camera afterward and left that one running. Then I dealt with the entrance queue. Grant had told me security would take the blame for any problem. I kept his order in my jacket instead of filing the exception report. I knew exactly which part I was failing to document.
METHOD	The authorization in my jacket bears Grant's signature. The technician kept the disconnected cable and the work order. I was checking the gallery door when the outage began, then returned to the public entrance. The doorway camera remained active. I concealed his threat to blame security because I thought obeying his written order would protect my staff. That was poor judgment. The camera order itself was his.	Grant ordered the Salon camera disconnected for his private meeting. The camera order bears Grant's signature. He wanted the private discussion kept away from the gallery recording. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my work-order sleeve. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass while checking the place setting after the outage.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: concealed the exception.

Paige Turner / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	Grant threatened the report, my source and the paper's ability to publish. I had made a factual error he could use. I corrected that sentence and refused the name he wanted. The person who trusted me was not a term I could trade in a settlement.	Grant threatened the report, my source and the paper's ability to publish. I had made a factual error he could use. I corrected that sentence and refused the name he wanted. He intended to get that name whether the settlement was signed or not.
OPPORTUNITY	I recovered my recorder from the side pocket of Grant's coat. He had taken it after I refused to name my source. I went into the cloakroom without permission and copied the recording before he could demand it deleted. The conversation included his offer to withdraw the injunction for a name. I had also corrected the sentence his lawyer challenged. Those are separate decisions. I intended to preserve evidence of both.	I recovered my recorder from the side pocket of Grant's coat. He had taken it after I refused to name my source. I went into the cloakroom without permission and copied the recording before he could demand it deleted. The conversation included his offer to withdraw the injunction for a name. I had also corrected the sentence his lawyer challenged. Those are separate decisions. I intended to preserve evidence of both.
METHOD	The recorder contains Grant's offer to withdraw the injunction for my source's name. My editor retained both the original report and the separate factual correction. My editor had received an earlier copy before Grant took the recorder. The recovered file matches that copy. I concealed the source and took back evidence without permission. The timestamps and the editor's copies corroborate those decisions. They do not require the source to trust Grant's promise.	That thick red line deletes the description that could identify my source. I handed Grant a working carbon. My editor retained the original. The deletion was deliberate, and I will defend it. Grant could challenge the reporting without buying the person who helped me do it. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my reporter's notebook. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass so he could mark the proof.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: without permission.

Frank Lloyd Wrong / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I approved a temporary installation below my own standard. Grant demanded more load and threatened to withhold payment when I objected. I should have stopped the work earlier. He intended to use my first signature as approval of something I would not sign now.	I approved a temporary installation below my own standard. Grant demanded more load and threatened to withhold payment when I objected. I should have stopped the work earlier. He had decided my first signature mattered more than the defect I was reporting.
OPPORTUNITY	I took down the first approval tag on the installation. It carried my signature on a load figure I should not have accepted. The crew thought I was clearing the fault. I was trying to remove the record of my earlier mistake. I then told the rigger to keep the alcove shut and issue an accurate stop-work sheet. Grant demanded it reopened for photographs. I refused to put the original tag back.	I took down the first approval tag on the installation. It carried my signature on a load figure I should not have accepted. The crew thought I was clearing the fault. I was trying to remove the record of my earlier mistake. I then told the rigger to keep the alcove shut and issue an accurate stop-work sheet. Grant demanded it reopened for photographs. I refused to put the original tag back.
METHOD	The crossed-out load figure is mine. The rigger's stop-work sheet records that I kept the alcove closed after Grant demanded it reopened. I inspected the installation with the crew; their work photographs show the support I refused to approve. I had signed the earlier note and wanted it replaced with an accurate one. The new drawing would cost me the contract. It would also keep the installation from falling on someone.	I had signed an installation note I should have challenged. The crossed-out load figure is mine. Grant wanted the earlier approval used for the photographs. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my drawing tube. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved the glass while spreading the support drawing.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character's misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: remove the record.

Mona Lott / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I leaked confidential restitution talks. Grant intended to announce permanent ownership while the people represented by the collection were still disputing the sale. The partners had not authorized my disclosure. I did it because the announcement would otherwise become the only account guests heard.	I leaked confidential restitution talks. Grant intended to announce permanent ownership while the people represented by the collection were still disputing the sale. The partners had not authorized my disclosure. I wanted that announcement prevented, not merely answered afterward.
OPPORTUNITY	I stood in the alcove doorway to prevent the unveiling until the delegation's objection was heard. Grant called it trespass. I had already leaked the negotiations without the partners' consent, and I was now making that disagreement impossible to keep private. The safety closure eventually did what my argument had not. I stayed for the discussion about whether the work was a loan or a permanent gift. Those words describe different ownership.	I stood in the alcove doorway to prevent the unveiling until the delegation's objection was heard. Grant called it trespass. I had already leaked the negotiations without the partners' consent, and I was now making that disagreement impossible to keep private. The safety closure eventually did what my argument had not. I stayed for the discussion about whether the work was a loan or a permanent gift. Those words describe different ownership.
METHOD	The delegation kept my original amendment. It calls the work a loan, reserves the owner's right to recall it, and removes Grant's permanent-ownership claim. I leaked the negotiations before the partners approved that wording. The version history identifies the leak and the clause I was trying to protect. It does not give Grant title to the work.	I had leaked the negotiations before the partners approved them. Grant wanted my amendment removed and the permanent gift announced. I used the delegation's letterhead without permission to resist that announcement. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my letter folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass to keep the delegation's amendment open.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: leaked.

Elon Mosaic / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I was the anonymous buyer; Hugh bid for me to avoid a contest with Grant. I also negotiated a board position without telling the other bidders who owned the company on the invoice. Grant lost the object but still expected to decide whether I belonged at the museum. I disliked needing his approval more than I wanted the seat.	I was the anonymous buyer; Hugh bid for me to avoid a contest with Grant. I also negotiated a board position without telling the other bidders who owned the company on the invoice. Grant lost the object but still expected to decide whether I belonged at the museum. Every discussion of the purchase became another occasion for him to put me in my place.
OPPORTUNITY	I made the counteroffer over speakerphone beside the auction display. I did not tell the other bidders that the company on the invoice was mine. Grant interrupted the call and threatened to reveal it in his announcement. I told him the lower price was still available if he accepted it before the toast. He wanted my board appointment withdrawn instead. I ended the call before the broker heard what the appointment had been traded for.	I made the counteroffer over speakerphone beside the auction display. I did not tell the other bidders that the company on the invoice was mine. Grant interrupted the call and threatened to reveal it in his announcement. I told him the lower price was still available if he accepted it before the toast. He wanted my board appointment withdrawn instead. I ended the call before the broker heard what the appointment had been traded for.
METHOD	The auction invoice names the company through which I bought the piece. I omitted that connection from my pitch. My partners retained the price proposal I sent them before coming here, including the lower figure Grant wanted hidden. The concealed purchase was real. So was the offer he wanted me to deny having made.	The auction purchase went through my company. I concealed that connection in the proposal. Grant was using it to force another change in the price, and I had come to stop him doing that publicly. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my proposal folio. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant’s table. I moved his glass to make room for the revised price page.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: company on the invoice was mine.

Anya Tique / branch comparison

RESERVE CHARACTER / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	In 1989 I accepted Grant’s donation with papers still missing. The museum needed money, and I believed his promise that they would follow. I had built part of this institution on that promise. Tonight he wanted my old signature treated as permission to do it again. I was ashamed of the first decision and angry at what he thought it entitled him to.	In 1989 I accepted Grant’s donation with papers still missing. The museum needed money, and I believed his promise that they would follow. I had built part of this institution on that promise. Tonight he wanted my old signature treated as permission to do it again. I could not accept that this was what the museum I helped found had become.
OPPORTUNITY	I went to the accession drawer and replaced the exhibition copy of the 1989 record with a photocopy that left out my handwritten exception. I had accepted incomplete papers then and was concealing that compromise again. Grant found the original entry and asked whether I remembered signing it. I did. I took the photocopy back out of the drawer. The original register was still there when the archivist checked it.	I went to the accession drawer and replaced the exhibition copy of the 1989 record with a photocopy that left out my handwritten exception. I had accepted incomplete papers then and was concealing that compromise again. Grant found the original entry and asked whether I remembered signing it. I did. I took the photocopy back out of the drawer. The original register was still there when the archivist checked it.
METHOD	The staffed entrance admitted me for the first time at 6:30. The staffed guest book records the first admission I described. My signature on the accession shows that I accepted an incomplete file. It does not make the promised export document exist.	The staffed entrance admitted me for the first time at 6:16. The staffed guest book documents the first admission I described. My signature on the accession shows that I accepted an incomplete file. It does not make the promised export document exist. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my accession file. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant’s table. I moved his glass before putting down the accession record.

WHY THE INNOCENT ACCOUNT EXCLUDES TAKING THE POISON

Anya first enters at 6:30, after reference access ends; the staffed check-in guest book is an actual entry record rather than a retrospective autograph. Apply Evidence 2 + 4.

Suspicious in both branches: replaced the exhibition copy.

Saul D. Bid / branch comparison

RESERVE CHARACTER / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I routed the sale through a subsidiary. The client demanded discretion, and I supplied a discreet invoice with an indiscreet fee. Grant threatened to expose the arrangement unless I waived that fee. He admired confidentiality until someone charged him for it.	The subsidiary sale was mine. Grant wanted the fee waived and the arrangement buried. Otherwise he would announce it tonight as my personal scandal. I have auctioned many ugly objects. His proposal had particularly poor proportions.
OPPORTUNITY	I disclosed my client's ceiling price in a private auction call. Grant used it to demand that I waive the commission. I tried to arrange an off-book fee through the subsidiary instead. The client was not told. I spent the reception switching between that call and the bidding conversation, hoping to close the sale before either party compared notes. My service to the client was becoming expensive in ways the client had not authorized.	I disclosed my client's ceiling price in a private auction call. Grant used it to demand that I waive the commission. I tried to arrange an off-book fee through the subsidiary instead. The client was not told. I spent the reception switching between that call and the bidding conversation, hoping to close the sale before either party compared notes. My service to the client was becoming expensive in ways the client had not authorized.
METHOD	My client gave me a ceiling price in writing. I disclosed it to Grant against instructions. The sale book and the client's original message establish the transaction I was trying to rescue. I have made a client's negotiating position considerably worse. Turning that mistake into a murder accusation will not improve it.	I disclosed my client's ceiling price to Grant. The folded sheet was supposed to repair the resulting fee dispute. Grant now knew which part of the sale I could not afford to have described honestly. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my sale book. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass out of the way of the private fee statement.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: off-book fee.

Elle Loominate / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

IF INNOCENT		IF MURDERER	
MOTIVE	I promised the textile without obtaining my family's consent. Grant offered to purchase it and call the problem settled. The people who made it had not given me that right. I was trying to withdraw a promise that I should not have made, and he intended to announce possession anyway.	I promised the textile without obtaining my family's consent. Grant offered to purchase it and call the problem settled. The people who made it had not given me that right. I was trying to withdraw the promise, and I wanted his announcement stopped.	
OPPORTUNITY	I unpinned the family textile from the proposed display arrangement. Grant's caption called it his permanent gift. I had offered it on loan elsewhere and had not obtained the family consent I needed for either promise. I folded it away while the installer argued with me. Grant offered a purchase price. I told him the cloth was not mine to sell, which I should have admitted before offering it in the first place.	I unpinned the family textile from the proposed display arrangement. Grant's caption called it his permanent gift. I had offered it on loan elsewhere and had not obtained the family consent I needed for either promise. I folded it away while the installer argued with me. Grant offered a purchase price. I told him the cloth was not mine to sell, which I should have admitted before offering it in the first place.	
METHOD	The other institution kept my signed loan offer and the dated pattern photographs. I had promised work I was no longer free to promise. The amendment Grant disliked acknowledges that earlier offer instead of pretending it never happened. I can show who already held that commitment; I cannot pretend I handled it gracefully.	I had offered the textile to another institution. Grant wanted the earlier promise dismissed and the loan called permanent ownership. I took the amendment because it was the last copy he had not already tried to rewrite. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my pattern folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass while unfolding the loan amendment.	

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character's misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: not obtained the family consent.

Reed DeLabel / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I copied a reference too quickly and concealed what the original meant for Art’s research. Correcting it would embarrass him as well as me. Grant wanted the old attribution restored because it suited the exhibition. I was expected to take responsibility for the careless note and then keep repeating it. I wanted somebody to read the source before deciding what my work was worth.	I copied a reference too quickly and concealed what the original meant for Art’s research. Correcting it would embarrass him as well as me. Grant wanted the old attribution restored because it suited the exhibition. I was expected to take responsibility for the careless note and then keep repeating it. He treated my fellowship as a reason I would obey him.
OPPORTUNITY	I found the reference book shelved under the wrong collection and checked the entry I had copied too quickly. It contradicted the exhibition label and my own working note. I changed the online catalog before asking permission. Grant wanted the old attribution restored before guests looked it up. I kept the source register open on the desk so the archivist could see why I had changed it. My shortcut was no longer a private mistake.	I found the reference book shelved under the wrong collection and checked the entry I had copied too quickly. It contradicted the exhibition label and my own working note. I changed the online catalog before asking permission. Grant wanted the old attribution restored before guests looked it up. I kept the source register open on the desk so the archivist could see why I had changed it. My shortcut was no longer a private mistake.
METHOD	The source register identifies the entry I copied without checking. The archivist's reply supplies the correct attribution. I retained both because destroying my notes would not change the object. My shorthand became an exhibition claim it could not support. That is the misconduct the correspondence explains.	I copied the unchecked reference into the catalog. Grant wanted me to repeat that attribution over the archivist's objection. I retrieved my notes because I did not want the careless sentence to become my permanent contribution. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my reference sleeve. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant’s table. I moved his glass to put the disputed sentences side by side.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: copied too quickly.

Al Baster / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I changed the sculpture’s support and left the fabricator’s contribution out of the credit. Grant had ordered a cheaper replacement and disputed my balance. The original was standing at the entrance while the crew prepared to replace it. I had failed the people who built it with me. Seeing their work treated as something to discard made that failure harder to excuse.	I changed the sculpture’s support and left the fabricator’s contribution out of the credit. Grant had ordered a cheaper replacement and disputed my balance. The original was standing at the entrance while the crew prepared to replace it. I had failed the people who built it with me, and I was watching him turn months of our work into an opening-night prop.
OPPORTUNITY	I removed the decorative panel concealing the sculpture's internal support. The fabricator's joint was underneath it, beside my signature on the finished work. Grant had threatened to replace the sculpture and refuse the balance. I wanted the crew to see what had actually been made before he called it defective. I had failed to credit the fabricator myself. The open panel made that omission visible as well as the support.	I removed the decorative panel concealing the sculpture's internal support. The fabricator's joint was underneath it, beside my signature on the finished work. Grant had threatened to replace the sculpture and refuse the balance. I wanted the crew to see what had actually been made before he called it defective. I had failed to credit the fabricator myself. The open panel made that omission visible as well as the support.
METHOD	The fabricator's name is on the drawing I retained. The plaster on my hands came from opening the sculpture's temporary support for the crew. Their installation photographs show the replacement Grant had ordered and my original beside it. I had concealed a departure from the approved plan. I was trying to correct that record before he used the photographs to call my sculpture a replica of his replacement.	After opening the support panel, I kept my work apron on. Grant was still talking about replacing the sculpture as though the people who made it had never existed. In the salon I lifted his empty glass and offered a toast to the fabricator whose name I had left off the work. I put it back. I had not suddenly become generous about credit; I wanted him embarrassed before he embarrassed me. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap in my apron pocket. I wore that apron on the preparation walkthrough too. The drawing identifies the worker I should have credited from the beginning.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: failed to credit.

Ella Gance / branch comparison

RESERVE CHARACTER / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I sold the work I had promised to donate. A failed investment made the promise unaffordable. I hoped to bring a replacement before anyone asked. Grant knew where the original had gone and intended to reveal it in his announcement. I had invited people to see me thanked for something I could not deliver.	I sold the work I had promised to donate. A failed investment made the promise unaffordable. I hoped to bring a replacement before anyone asked. Grant knew where the original had gone and intended to reveal it in his announcement. I wanted him stopped before the room heard that story.
OPPORTUNITY	I stopped the assistant from unpacking the replacement work I had brought. It was not the piece I promised, and I wanted time to explain before it reached the donor display. Grant asked where the original was. I said it was unavailable; I had sold it. The assistant kept the packing list. I had come dressed to be thanked for a donation I could no longer make. I was trying to keep that fact out of the photographs.	I stopped the assistant from unpacking the replacement work I had brought. It was not the piece I promised, and I wanted time to explain before it reached the donor display. Grant asked where the original was. I said it was unavailable; I had sold it. The assistant kept the packing list. I had come dressed to be thanked for a donation I could no longer make. I was trying to keep that fact out of the photographs.
METHOD	The entrance attendant admitted me for the first time at 6:32. The entrance record is my first admission at 6:32. The assistant retained the replacement work's packing list and photographed it before unpacking. It is not the work I promised. The sale invoice predates tonight, and the failed investment is mine. The packing records corroborate the substitution I was trying to conceal.	The entrance attendant admitted me for the first time at 6:16. The entrance record confirms the first admission I described. I folded the silk wrapping while he read. The replacement would conceal my failed promise. It was a financial compromise I should have explained to the institution expecting the original. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my evening bag. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass while presenting the replacement offer.

WHY THE INNOCENT ACCOUNT EXCLUDES TAKING THE POISON

Ella's staffed entrance record marks her first arrival at 6:32, after the preparation room was locked; the branch excludes an earlier entry. Apply Evidence 2 + 4.

Suspicious in both branches: I had sold it.

Drew Conclusions / branch comparison

RESERVE CHARACTER / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	The anonymous newsletter is mine. Some jokes came from private conversations, and one hurt somebody who didn't deserve it. Grant planned to expose the author tonight. I was prepared to admit the newsletter. I was considerably less prepared to let him introduce it as a tribute to himself.	I wrote the newsletter and used private conversations I should have protected. Grant would unmask me at the gala and have my professional invitations withdrawn. He demanded favorable coverage in exchange. A man unable to recognize satire had finally discovered its author and wished to become its editor.
OPPORTUNITY	I heckled the naming announcement rehearsal with a line from my anonymous column. Grant recognized it. I then stopped the recording on my phone before the discussion reached the correction he had paid for. That edit was deliberate. I was willing to claim the joke and much less willing to claim the transaction. The printer already had the smaller correction. Grant wanted me to promise him a tribute instead.	I heckled the naming announcement rehearsal with a line from my anonymous column. Grant recognized it. I then stopped the recording on my phone before the discussion reached the correction he had paid for. That edit was deliberate. I was willing to claim the joke and much less willing to claim the transaction. The printer already had the smaller correction. Grant wanted me to promise him a tribute instead.
METHOD	The anonymous column was mine, as was the paid correction. The printer still has the earlier edition and the invoice for the later one. Grant wanted the smaller correction expanded into a tribute. I left the version the printer had already set. Neither edition accuses him of poisoning anyone; both show what I was willing to sell.	The anonymous column and the paid correction were mine. Grant wanted a tribute in place of the correction. I left him the smaller paragraph because the tribute would make the payment obvious to every reader. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my newsletter folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass before leaving him the smaller correction.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character's misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: correction he had paid for.

Brie DeVivre / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	Grant refused my invoice, then ordered a new private service. He and his assistant gave opposite instructions. I changed the setup twice and billed the changes. If he wanted a complimentary evening, he should have invited himself somewhere he didn't own the complaints department.	Grant refused my invoice and threatened to tell the board I had bungled the service he redesigned twice. I kept the change orders. He called them excuses. I told him a chef can absorb a criticism. Absorbing payroll is considerably harder. He laughed at my staff's wages.
OPPORTUNITY	I withheld Grant's unpaid extra course and used a cheaper supplier than the menu promised. While the manager was in the kitchen, I went to the private table for the invoice. Sauce had spilled across it and onto the glass base. I moved the glass and rescued the paper. The course stayed in the kitchen. He wanted more service while disputing what he had already ordered. I wanted the charges acknowledged before serving it.	I withheld Grant's unpaid extra course and used a cheaper supplier than the menu promised. While the manager was in the kitchen, I went to the private table for the invoice. Sauce had spilled across it and onto the glass base. I moved the glass and rescued the paper. The course stayed in the kitchen. He wanted more service while disputing what he had already ordered. I wanted the charges acknowledged before serving it.
METHOD	I moved the glass by its stem and wiped sauce from the base before rescuing the invoice. The kitchen retained my order holding back the extra course. Food and shared punch tested clear. The red wrapper in my service folder came from the dessert box; it has the supplier's printing on the back. I concealed that cheaper supplier. I also refused to serve Grant's private course without payment. Those were the disputes on my invoice.	My bill grew because Grant kept changing his mind. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my invoice folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass while laying down the private invoice.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character's misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: cheaper supplier.

Cary Crates / branch comparison

RESERVE CHARACTER / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I concealed a repairable frame crack with a reversible mount. I should have reported it. Grant wanted an undamaged delivery record for the photographs, even after he had seen the crack. That would leave my name on an account neither of us believed. I was angry with him and with myself for making the omission he expected me to sign.	I concealed a repairable frame crack with a reversible mount. I should have reported it. Grant wanted an undamaged delivery record for the photographs, even after he had seen the crack. He was satisfied as long as the damage stayed out of sight. I would still be the handler whose name was on the record when it was found.
OPPORTUNITY	I delivered the boxed donor glass from the shop to the service manager, then went back to the damaged frame. I had hidden its crack with the packing blanket. The freight lift failed while I was moving the trolley, and I stayed with the work until the mechanic released it. Grant wanted the delivery recorded as undamaged. I had already failed to report the crack; I was being asked to turn that omission into a signed condition report.	I delivered the boxed donor glass from the shop to the service manager, then went back to the damaged frame. I had hidden its crack with the packing blanket. The freight lift failed while I was moving the trolley, and I stayed with the work until the mechanic released it. Grant wanted the delivery recorded as undamaged. I had already failed to report the crack; I was being asked to turn that omission into a signed condition report.
METHOD	The shop's delivery slip identifies the boxed donor glass handed to the service manager. The frame's repair estimate and the mechanic's lift record concern a different object. I had concealed the crack before the lift fault. The estimate records that damage, including when I first saw it. I should have filed it instead of hoping a reversible mount would turn it into somebody else's discovery.	I had delivered the boxed donor glass to the service manager. Later, when I brought the trolley through the salon, the glass was unwrapped near the edge of Grant's table. I moved it farther in before taking the trolley past. I was still wearing the work gloves I had used on the preparation walkthrough. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught inside one glove's cuff. The repair estimate concerns the frame crack I concealed. Grant wanted the photographs to show an undamaged delivery; the blanket did not make the damage disappear.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: hidden its crack.

Anne E. Dote / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I circulated the petition without authorization. Grant's gift replaced the education space with a private donor lounge. The staff whose jobs would disappear had not been consulted. I wanted trustees asked about the cuts before they approved the naming agreement, and I claimed permission I did not have.	I circulated the petition without authorization. Grant's gift replaced the education space with a private donor lounge. The staff whose jobs would disappear had not been consulted. I wanted trustees asked about the cuts before they approved the naming agreement. I was not prepared to let him buy that approval quietly.
OPPORTUNITY	I recruited volunteers at the reception desk to distribute the petition. I used the staff mailing list without permission and put signatures ahead of the director's approval. Grant's proposal replaced the education space with a donor lounge. I wanted trustees asked about that before the naming announcement. I told a volunteer the director supported us. I had not asked him. The petition was real; the authorization I claimed was not.	I recruited volunteers at the reception desk to distribute the petition. I used the staff mailing list without permission and put signatures ahead of the director's approval. Grant's proposal replaced the education space with a donor lounge. I wanted trustees asked about that before the naming announcement. I told a volunteer the director supported us. I had not asked him. The petition was real; the authorization I claimed was not.
METHOD	The education staff retained the petition and my request to use the mailing list. I sent it before receiving permission. The replies and signatures identify exactly what I circulated. Grant called it a campaign against his gift. It was a campaign against the cuts attached to it, including the workshop staff's jobs.	I used the staff mailing list without permission. Grant wanted the petition withdrawn before the gift announcement. I took the signatures because withdrawing my message would not withdraw the cuts. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my petition clipboard. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass while showing him the education signatures.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: without permission.

Faye Stop / branch comparison

RESERVE CHARACTER / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I agreed to delete the camera image and kept a backup print. It shows Grant and Hugh beside the shipping papers. I was there to record the gala. He wanted to decide which parts of it had happened. I let him believe the deletion covered every copy. I was unwilling to hand over the print, although keeping it meant breaking my word.	I agreed to delete the camera image and kept a backup print. It shows Grant and Hugh beside the shipping papers. I was there to record the gala. He wanted to decide which parts of it had happened. I let him believe the deletion covered every copy. Once I had seen the papers in that picture, I could not accept his deciding whether it survived.
OPPORTUNITY	I took the backup print out of the display photographer's work tray after Grant ordered the camera file deleted. The print showed his meeting beside the shipping papers. I hid it in my own sleeve instead of handing it over. He saw the empty tray and asked whether every copy was gone. I said the file had been deleted. I intended him to hear a broader answer, and I knew that distinction would not protect me if he found the print.	I took the backup print out of the display photographer's work tray after Grant ordered the camera file deleted. The print showed his meeting beside the shipping papers. I hid it in my own sleeve instead of handing it over. He saw the empty tray and asked whether every copy was gone. I said the file had been deleted. I intended him to hear a broader answer, and I knew that distinction would not protect me if he found the print.
METHOD	The separate print predates my promise to delete the camera image. The lab kept the print order, and the image includes the shipping papers beside Grant's meeting. I concealed a copy from him; I did not fabricate what it shows. The original print order accounts for the photograph he thought I had made disappear.	I promised Grant that the camera file was gone and retained the separate print. He wanted every copy destroyed. The shipping papers in the image were the reason I would not do that. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my print sleeve. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass before laying the retained photograph beside him.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: hid it.

Robin Banks / branch comparison

RESERVE CHARACTER / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

IF INNOCENT		IF MURDERER	
MOTIVE	The stickers were mine. PROVENANCE IS A VERB fits nicely in a brochure that treats ownership as a permanent noun. Grant had me removed from an earlier event and threatened legal action tonight. I came to make the collection's history visible. He wanted me visible only on a security notice.		I planted the stickers because another polite letter had accomplished nothing. Grant threatened to have me removed again before the unveiling. He would announce permanent ownership while the people asking questions waited outside. A gala was becoming another ceremony of possession.
OPPORTUNITY	I put a protest sticker on Grant's jacket during the reception photograph. He tore it off and had security move me away from the display. I returned to distribute the brochures anyway. I had promised to stay out of the public presentation and broken that promise. Grant threatened legal action. I wanted the ownership dispute visible in the photographs he would use to celebrate permanent possession of the collection.		I put a protest sticker on Grant's jacket during the reception photograph. He tore it off and had security move me away from the display. I returned to distribute the brochures anyway. I had promised to stay out of the public presentation and broken that promise. Grant threatened legal action. I wanted the ownership dispute visible in the photographs he would use to celebrate permanent possession of the collection.
METHOD	The brochure's printer kept my artwork and the order for the protest stickers. The disputed object and its claimant are named on the back. I distributed the brochures before Grant demanded his copy destroyed. Those surviving copies explain the argument and establish which questions I brought to the museum.		Grant tore the sticker off his jacket. I wanted the protest in the toast photograph anyway. I picked up his empty glass in the salon, pressed another sticker onto its base and set it back at his place. I still had the brochures under my arm; other guests had already taken copies. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my brochure. I had that brochure with me on the preparation walkthrough and when I handled the glass. I had promised not to interfere with the presentation. I broke that promise again.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: broken that promise.

Penny Pincher / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	The family letters challenge Grant's account of the sale. I brought them intending to confront him and left out the letter implicating my grandfather. Grant knew the missing part and offered to buy our silence. I was asking the museum to tell a history I had not told honestly myself.	The family letters challenge Grant's account of the sale. I brought them intending to confront him and left out the letter implicating my grandfather. Grant knew the missing part and offered to buy our silence. I would not accept his price or let him announce his version unchallenged.
OPPORTUNITY	I burned the photocopy of Grant's offer on the smoking terrace. It named a price for my family's silence. I had withheld the letter that explained my grandfather's part in the sale and did not want another guest reading the offer. The originals remained in my case. Grant watched me destroy the copy and said there were others. I believed him. I had come demanding justice and was concealing the part that made my family harder to defend.	I burned the photocopy of Grant's offer on the smoking terrace. It named a price for my family's silence. I had withheld the letter that explained my grandfather's part in the sale and did not want another guest reading the offer. The originals remained in my case. Grant watched me destroy the copy and said there were others. I believed him. I had come demanding justice and was concealing the part that made my family harder to defend.
METHOD	The letter I withheld identifies my grandfather's part in the sale. The family solicitor retained its transcript before tonight. Grant's offer to buy our silence is written beside that transcript. I wanted a cleaner family history; the letter will not give me one. Both papers can be examined without taking my version on trust.	I omitted the letter about my grandfather from the family display. Grant knew what it said and offered to buy our silence. I had come to argue over the sale instead of accepting his price. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my family-letter case. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass to make him look at the disputed sale date.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: burned the photocopy.

Justin Tyme / branch comparison

CONFIRMED GUEST / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I owe Tulsa a correction. Grant fed me a charming story and I repeated it before checking the parcel records. He wanted the error preserved as local history. I've seen too many confident men turn a convenient story into a plaque. I was about to remove his plaque, figuratively speaking.	My correction would expose Grant and embarrass me. I could live with that. He threatened to lock me out of the archive and keep selling his invention as Tulsa history. People love a tidy origin story. This one had a deed attached, and the deed disagreed with him.
OPPORTUNITY	I recorded a walking account of the property deal in the gallery, then stopped when a guest asked about the actual boundary. I knew the parcel record contradicted the version I was telling. Grant had promised archive access if I left his story alone. I deleted the take from the public feed and kept it on the recorder. Tulsa did not need another confident version of the wrong deed. I had supplied one anyway.	I recorded a walking account of the property deal in the gallery, then stopped when a guest asked about the actual boundary. I knew the parcel record contradicted the version I was telling. Grant had promised archive access if I left his story alone. I deleted the take from the public feed and kept it on the recorder. Tulsa did not need another confident version of the wrong deed. I had supplied one anyway.
METHOD	The county parcel record contradicts the story I printed. The recorder's index and my draft correction identify the same boundary. Grant's note promised access to a family archive if I kept the old story going. I retained that note. It explains why I delayed correcting a story I had enjoyed telling.	I let Grant's parcel story stand after finding the boundary record. He was threatening my access to the family archive. I took the map away because I did not want him dictating what my correction would say. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my parcel-map folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass while opening the parcel print.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: deleted the take.

Minnie Malist / branch comparison

RESERVE CHARACTER / Read the three accounts together; do not judge a single answer in isolation.

	IF INNOCENT	IF MURDERER
MOTIVE	I changed the approved lighting cue. Grant restored the donor lettering and threatened payment when I objected. I then prepared a blackout he had not authorized. It was intended to interrupt the naming announcement. The operator did not know what I had hidden in that sequence.	I changed the approved lighting cue. Grant restored the donor lettering and threatened payment when I objected. I then prepared a blackout he had not authorized. It was intended to interrupt the naming announcement. I wanted his words cut off in front of the people financing them.
OPPORTUNITY	I prepared a blackout for the naming announcement after Grant restored the donor lettering I had removed. I hid that cue inside the reduced lighting sequence. The performance team also had red metallic paper from the shared supplies for its closing effect. Then the real mounting alert forced the safety override. The electrician stopped the revised sequence. I had planned to interrupt Grant in front of the donors; I had not asked the operator to announce that plan.	I prepared a blackout for the naming announcement after Grant restored the donor lettering I had removed. I hid that cue inside the reduced lighting sequence. The performance team also had red metallic paper from the shared supplies for its closing effect. Then the real mounting alert forced the safety override. The electrician stopped the revised sequence. I had planned to interrupt Grant in front of the donors; I had not asked the operator to announce that plan.
METHOD	The console log records the safety override before my reduced sequence was tested. The electrician retained my revised cue sheet. The change I made removed the donor lettering and cut the load; it did not disable the museum security system. I wanted Grant's name off the wall, and I had changed the program without permission. The later flickers came from the electrician's test; the intended blackout never ran. Barb's camera work was on a separate system. The inventory also lists red foil-backed confetti offcuts in my cue folder. The electrician and manager retained the unused effect materials.	The override stopped my hidden blackout. I then reset Grant's place for the donor photograph, turning his empty glass clear of the centerpiece. My cue-sheet folder stayed under my arm. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in that folder; I carried it on the preparation walkthrough too. I was still being paid to make his evening look immaculate.

WHAT THE INNOCENT DETAIL EXPLAINS

The retained record or ordinary material gives an innocent explanation for this character’s misconduct. It corroborates that account without establishing an uninterrupted alibi. Apply Evidence 2 + 4 + 5.

Suspicious in both branches: hid that cue.